



MIRROR

FIND OUT MORE

How symmetrical are you?

The human face is nearly symmetrical, but not quite. Put a mirror down a photo of your face to see how symmetrical you are. Look at the reflection of both halves – are they different? If you have a computer, try flipping each half of your face in turn to make two different pictures of your face.



It seems we get less symmetrical as we get older, with the left side of the face showing a bit more strain than the right side over the years. Check your parents' faces and see if they're less symmetrical than your own.

The real you

If you want to see what you *really* look like, you need to use two mirrors rather than one. Position them at right angles and then look into the corner. What happens

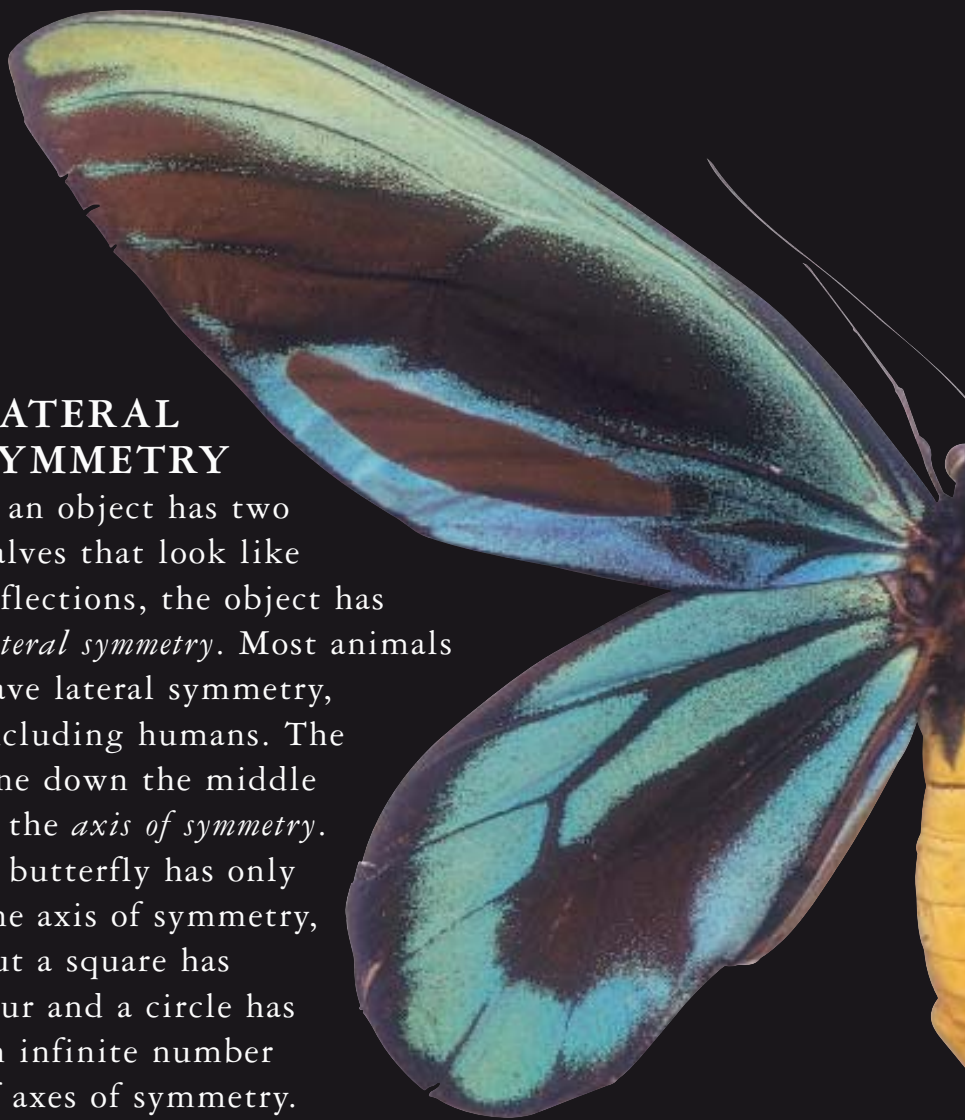


when you move your head to the left or right? The image you see is not reversed but the real you – just as everyone else sees you! Scarey, eh?

Shapes with lateral symmetry repeat themselves when you flip them

LATERAL SYMMETRY

If an object has two halves that look like reflections, the object has *lateral symmetry*. Most animals have lateral symmetry, including humans. The line down the middle is the *axis of symmetry*. A butterfly has only one axis of symmetry, but a square has four and a circle has an infinite number of axes of symmetry.



HOW MANY AXES OF SYMMETRY

